PBM Data Specification

The data a plan sponsor should request to evaluate its pharmacy benefit

EDITION 2026.1 · JULY 2026

PURPOSE	A standard request specification for pharmacy and medical claims data, so plan sponsors ask for the same fields in the same format every time
AUDIENCE	Plan sponsors, their advisors, and the vendors responding to a data request
BASIS	Fiduciary duties under ERISA and the disclosure obligations of the Consolidated Appropriations Act of 2021 and 2026
ONLINE	nautilushealth.org/pbm · contractxray.com

Introduction

As fiduciaries under the Consolidated Appropriations Act (CAA) of 2021, we are obligated to act in the best interest of plan participants. To meet this obligation, we are requesting full access to eligibility data, medical and pharmacy claims, contract terms, and related plan documentation.

This information is required to evaluate plan performance, ensure cost-effectiveness, and improve participant outcomes, core responsibilities under ERISA and the CAA.

Pursuant to the CAA's Gag Clause Prohibition and recent Department of Labor guidance, no agreement may restrict employer access to cost, quality, or performance data. All requested information must be provided in full, without redaction or contractual limitation. Any refusal must be accompanied by a written explanation and the legal basis for non-disclosure.

1. Background Plan Information

To understand plan demographics, utilization trends, and cost variation, please provide:

- **Total Number of Employees Covered**
- **Total Number of Covered Lives** (employees + dependents)
- **Demographic Summary** (Age, Gender, Family Status, States, etc.)
- **Employment Summary** (Tenure, Job Category, Income Levels, etc.)
- **Summary Plan Descriptions (SPD)**
- **Plan Design** (Copay Structure, Deductibles, Out-of-Pocket Max, Coinsurance, etc.)
- **Formulary and Tiering** (Full Formulary List, Exclusions, Carve-outs, etc.)
- **Utilization Management**(Prior Authorization, Step Therapy, Quantity Limits, etc.)
- **Claim Processing** (Workflow, Appeals, Reimbursement, etc.)
- **Latest Renewal Projection**
- **RxDC Report**

2. Pharmacy Benefit Claims (PBM) Data

To analyze prescription drug spending, rebate structures, utilization trends and population health outcomes, please provide a detailed dataset of **all "net-paid" pharmacy claims**, including but not limited to:

Claim-Level Required Fields

`plan_name`	The name of the plan.
`plan_id`	The unique ID of the plan.
`group_name`	The name of the group.
`group_id`	The unique ID of the group.
`claim_id`	The unique ID of the claim.
`member_id`	The unique ID of the member being prescribed the medication.
`member_first`	The first name of the member.
`member_last`	The last name of the member.
`member_dob`	The date of birth for the member (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
`member_sex`	The sex of the member.
`member_race`	The race of the member.
`member_city`	The physical city the member resides in.
`member_zip`	The physical 5-digit zip code the member resides in.
`member_relation`	The member's relation to the employee (e.g., dependent, spouse, etc.).
`pharmacy_npi`	The National Provider Identifier (NPI) of the pharmacy where the prescription was dispensed (e.g., 705938172).
`pharmacy_name`	The pharmacy where the prescription was dispensed.
`prescriber_npi`	The National Provider Identifier (NPI) number of the prescriber who wrote the prescription (e.g., 705938172).
`prescriber_name`	The name of the prescriber who wrote the original prescription.
`rx_num`	The unique ID for the prescription, typically assigned by the pharmacy.
`fill_num`	The number associated with the specific fill of the rx number.
`fill_left`	The number of fills remaining for the rx number.
`fill_date`	The date when the pharmacy filled the prescription (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
`bill_date`	The date when the prescription was billed (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
`adj_date`	The date when the prescription was adjudicated (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
`ndc`	The 11-digit National Drug Code (NDC) for the medication that was dispensed (e.g., 50234164823).
`drug_name`	The name and strength of the medication that was dispensed by the pharmacy.
`drug_form`	The form of the medication that was dispensed by the pharmacy.

thera_class	The therapeutic class of the dispensed medication (e.g., antihypertensive, antidiabetic).
gpi_code	The 14-digit generic product identifier of the dispensed medication.
qty_disp	The quantity of the medication dispensed by the pharmacy.
days_supply	The number of days for which the dispensed medication is intended to last.
daw	The 'Dispense As Written' code.
otc	The indicator that the drug is sold over the counter (e.g., Y, N).
compound	The indicator that the drug is a compound (e.g., Y, N).
prior_auth	The indicator that the claim has a prior authorization associated (e.g., Y, N).
step_ther	The indicator that the claim went through step therapy (e.g., Y, N).
formulary	The indicator that the drug is on the formulary (e.g., Y, N).
formulary_tier	The Tier or Level of the Formulary that the medication falls within (e.g., 1, 2).
formulary_desc	The description of the Formulary Tier (e.g., zero copay, generic, preferred brand).
network_channel	The channel description within the formulary (e.g., Retail 30, Retail 90, Specialty, Mail).
maintenance	The indicator that the drug is considered a maintenance medication (e.g., Y, N).
specialty	The indicator that the drug is considered a specialty medication (e.g., Y, N).
is_340b	The indicator that the drug is considered a 340B claim (e.g., Y, N).
generic	The indicator that the drug is considered generic (e.g., Y, N).
rebate	The indicator that the drug is considered rebate eligible (e.g., Y, N).
rebate_amt	The rebate amount associated with the claim.
pricing_basis	The pricing basis used for the claim (e.g., AWP, U&C, MAC).
unit_awp	The AWP unit price at the time of claim.
total_awp	The total AWP price at the time of claim.
copay	The amount of the claim paid by the member.
plan_pay	The amount of the claim paid by the plan, net of dispense fee.
disp_fee	The dispensing fee associated with the prescription.
sales_tax	The tax associated with the sale of the prescription.
px_ing_sub	The ingredient cost submitted by the dispensing pharmacy.
ing_pay	The ingredient cost remitted to the pharmacy by the carrier.
px_disp_sub	The dispensing fee submitted by the dispensing pharmacy.
disp_pay	The dispensing fee remitted to the pharmacy by the carrier.
member_ded	The amount of money applied to the members' deductible requirements.
admin_fee	The total amount of fees for administrative services associated with the claim.

anc_fee	The total amount of fees for ancillary services associated with the claim (e.g., PA, Step Therapy).
total_pay	The total amount of the claim (fees, taxes, copay, plan pay).
cob	The indicator that the claim has coordination of benefits (e.g., Y, N).
cob_amt	The amount to be paid by the other carrier.

3. Medical Benefit Claims & Physician-Administered Drugs

To evaluate medical benefit drug spending, especially for physician-administered drugs billed under J-codes and Q-codes, please provide a detailed dataset covering **all drugs billed through the medical benefit**, including but not limited to:

Claim-Level Required Fields

plan_name	The name of the plan.
plan_id	The unique ID of the plan.
group_name	The name of the group.
group_id	The unique ID of the group.
claim_id	The unique ID of the claim.
claim_type	The specific type of encounter (e.g., medical, dental, etc.).
service_type	A single digit alpha or numeric value codes that describes the type of service rendered. (e.g., 01-Medical Care, 02-Surgery, 03- Consultation).
claim_status	The status of the claim (e.g., paid, denied, reversed).
claim_line	The line number assigned to the specific charge line.
member_id	The unique ID of the member associated with the claim.
member_first	The first name of the member.
member_last	The last name of the member.
member_dob	The date of birth for the member (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
member_sex	The sex of the member.
member_race	The race of the member.
member_city	The physical city the member resides in.
member_zip	The physical 5-digit zip code the member resides in.
member_relation	The member's relation to the employee (e.g., dependent, spouse, etc.).
render_npi	The National Provider Identifier (NPI) number of the rendering provider (e.g., 705938172).
render_name	The name of the rendering provider associated with the member claim.
pos	The place of service code associated with the type of facility the service was performed (e.g., 21, 22, 23), CMS standard list.

billing_npi	The National Provider Identifier (NPI) number of the billing provider (e.g., 705938172).
billing_name	The name of the billing provider associated with the member claim.
network_ind	The network affiliation with the plan (e.g., in-network, out-of-network).
dos	The date of service that the drug was administered (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
prior_auth	The indicator that the claim has a prior authorization associated (e.g., Y, N).
ndc	The 11-digit National Drug Code (NDC) for the medication that was administered (e.g., 50234164823).
proc_code	The procedure code (HCPCS, CPT) identifying the drug billed for the claim.
qty_bill	The number of units billed under the procedure code for the claim. Use 1 if not provided.
proc_basis	The unit or basis for measurement code for the procedure code billed (e.g., GR, ML, UN).
mod1	The 2-character modifier used with the procedure code, if applicable (e.g., JW)
qty_waste	The number of units of the drug discarded due to single-use vial policy.
rev_code	The standard revenue code associated with the claim.
diag_prim	The primary ICD code, tied to medical necessity.
diag_sec	The secondary ICD code, tied to medical necessity.
diag_tert	The tertiary ICD code, tied to medical necessity.
amt_bill	The amount the provider billed for the drug claim.
amt_allow	The amount allowed by insurance for the drug claim.
amt_pay	The amount reimbursed to the provider.
coinsurance	The amount of the claim applied to the member's coinsurance.
deductible	The amount of the claim applied to the member's deductible.
copay	The amount of the claim paid by the member, net of sales tax.
plan_pay	The amount of the claim paid by the plan.
sales_tax	The tax associated with the encounter.
admin_fee	The total amount of fees for administrative services associated with the claim.
anc_fee	The total amount of fees for ancillary services associated with the claim (e.g., PA, Step Therapy).
total_pay	The total amount of the claim (fees, taxes, copay, plan pay).
cob	The indicator that the claim has coordination of benefits (e.g., Y, N).
cob_allowed	The COB amount allowed.
cob_paid	The COB amount paid.

4. Plan Eligibility File

To evaluate plan spending, utilization trends and population health outcomes, please provide a detailed dataset covering **all eligibility data for employees and dependents** for the last 12 months, including but not limited to:

Record-Level Required Fields

`plan_name`	The name of the plan.
`plan_id`	The unique ID of the plan.
`group_name`	The name of the group.
`group_id`	The unique ID of the group.
`subscriber_id`	The unique ID of the plan subscriber.
`member_id`	The unique ID of the member associated to the plan subscriber.
`member_first`	The first name of the member.
`member_last`	The last name of the member.
`member_dob`	The date of birth for the member (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
`member_sex`	The sex of the member.
`member_race`	The race of the member.
`member_city`	The physical city the member resides in.
`member_state`	The physical state the member resides in.
`member_zip`	The physical 5-digit zip code the member resides in.
`member_relation`	The member's relation to the employee (e.g., dependent, spouse, etc.).
`member_email`	The email of the member.
`member_phone`	The phone number of the member - no dashes, parenthesis, or preceding 1. (e.g., 4405789104)
`eligible_status`	The eligibility status of the member (e.g., Y, N).
`eligible_type`	The type of eligibility (e.g., Active, Retired, Cobra, Termed, Family, Single, etc.)
`effective_date`	The date the member first became eligible for benefits (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).
`term_date`	The date the member no longer had benefits (e.g., YYYY-MM-DD).

5. Plan Contracts & Financial Terms

To evaluate **cost efficiency and compliance with fiduciary obligations**, we require full transparency into **contractual agreements and financial terms**, including:

- **PBM Contract** (Including Rebate Terms, Network Discounts, and any applicable pricing methodologies)
- **Third-Party Administrator (TPA) Contract**
- **Stop-Loss Insurance Contract**
- **Performance Guarantees & Minimum Discount Guarantees (AWP Minus %)**

- **Administrative Fees and Any Other Service-Related Charges**

6. Data Delivery & Compliance

To ensure consistency and usability, please follow these guidelines for data delivery:

- **File Format:** CSV (preferred) with clear column headers and standardized data fields
- **Date Format:** YYYY-MM-DD
- **Missing Data Representation:** Use 'NA' for missing values
- **Data Dictionary:** Provide a description of any additional fields provided in the dataset
- **Security & HIPAA Compliance:** Data will be handled in accordance with HIPAA regulations
- **Delivery Method:** Secure file transfer or encrypted email

7. Contact & Submission Details

Please direct all inquiries and submit completed data files to:

[Requesting Organization Contact Name]

[Organization Name]
[Email Address]
[Phone Number]

Requested data should be provided by **[Submission Deadline]**.

We appreciate your support and look forward to working together on this evaluation.

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